UNIVERSITY OF NUEVA CACERES

School of Computer and Information Sciences

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology • Naga City, Camarines Sur

STAKEHOLDER INTERVIEW GUIDE

Target Office: Municipal Assessor's Office — Municipality of San Fernando, Camarines Sur

Research Project: Needs Assessment and Development of an Automated Real Property Tax Assessment and Digital Collection Framework for the Municipality of San Fernando: Optimizing Local Revenue Generation and Taxpayer Compliance Workflows

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Interview Purpose: To understand your daily office workflows, requirements, manual tax computation steps, and counter bottlenecks to design a helpful and easy-to-use web portal for the Assessor's Office.

Confidentiality Notice: All information shared will be kept strictly confidential and used solely for academic research in full compliance with the **Data Privacy Act (Republic Act No. 10173)**.

Note for the Interviewee: This interview is conducted by the student research team to gather firsthand practical insights. A printed copy is provided for your reference and review during our discussion.

PART 1 — OFFICE SETUP AND STAFF ROLES

1. How many staff members currently work in the Municipal Assessor's Office, and what are their main roles (such as Municipal Assessor, appraisers, tax mappers, records clerks, or counter staff)?

2. On average, about how many property tax transactions or client requests does your office handle in a typical day, and during peak deadline months?

3. What are the most common requests, certifications, or documents that property owners ask for at your counter?

PART 2 — DAILY WORKFLOWS AND TAX COMPUTATION

4. Can you walk us through the step-by-step process from the moment a taxpayer arrives at your service counter until they receive their finished document or clearance?

5. What specific documentary requirements must property owners submit for each of the following major transactions?

- **a. New Tax Declaration:** Requirements for newly declared land, new buildings/houses, or machinery.
- **b. Transfer of Ownership:** Requirements when transferring a property (such as Deed of Sale, BIR tax clearance, transfer tax receipt, or previous clearances).
- **c. Reassessment of Property:** Requirements when an owner requests a value correction, property reclassification, or physical inspection.
- **d. Issuance of Clearances:** Requirements for getting a Tax Clearance, Certificate of No Property, or Certificate of No Improvement.

Sample Document Request: If possible, our team kindly asks for blank or sample copies of your appraisal sheet, tax declaration, notice of assessment, or clearance forms to help us design the digital templates.

6. Once documents are submitted at the counter, how do staff verify them, and who reviews and approves the application before it is released?

7. How do you compute real property taxes in your office from start to finish?

- **a. Market Value & Assessed Value:** How do you determine market value, and what assessment percentages are applied based on classification (residential, agricultural, commercial)?
- **b. Tax Rates:** What tax percentages are applied to get the annual tax due (such as the 1% basic tax and 1% Special Education Fund)?
- **c. Discounts and Penalties:** What discounts are given for prompt or advance payments, and what interest or penalties are charged for late payments?

8. Where and how are your property records and assessment rolls currently stored (such as physical logbooks, paper folders, computer files, or a mix of both)?

9. How do personnel search for an existing property record, tax declaration, or property identification number when a client inquires at the counter?

PART 3 — BOTTLENECKS, DELAYS, AND COMMON ERRORS

10. On average, how long does it take to complete one full transaction from initial queuing to document release? Roughly how many minutes are spent on:

- **a. Requirement Checking:** Checking if the client's submitted papers are complete (minutes).
- **b. Record Search:** Locating the property in physical record books, maps, or file folders (minutes).
- **c. Value & Tax Computation:** Calculating the assessed value and tax amounts (minutes).
- **d. Approval & Release:** Review, official signature, municipal seal, and releasing the document (minutes).

11. During busy peak seasons (such as the January to March tax discount period), what are the biggest causes of long lines and delays in the office?

12. How often do calculation mistakes or clerical errors happen during manual tax computations, what usually causes them, and how are they corrected?

13. Which types of transactions most frequently require clients to return repeatedly (pabalik-balik) due to lacking documents or corrections?

14. Which transactions require coordinating with other offices (such as the Municipal Treasurer's Office, BIR, or Registry of Deeds), and how is that coordination handled right now?

PART 4 — RECORD KEEPING AND NATIONAL RULES

15. How are important physical documents — such as property assessment sheets, tax maps, and record books — organized and protected against loss, wear, fire, or water damage?

16. Does your office currently use any software program, computerized spreadsheet, or electronic database for recording or calculating assessments? If yes, what is it and what does it do?

17. Are there any recent national government guidelines or new property valuation rules that your office has started preparing for or implementing?

18. Where and in what format is your municipality's official Schedule of Market Values kept and referenced in your daily work (such as printed binders, spreadsheets, or a database)?

PART 5 — PUBLIC SERVICE AND TAXPAYER EXPERIENCE

19. What are the most frequent questions, complaints, or points of confusion that property owners express regarding assessments and clearances?

20. Approximately how much of your staff's daily time is spent answering basic questions (such as asking for requirements or checking status) from walk-in clients or phone inquiries?

21. Have property owners or taxpayers expressed interest in being able to check requirements, track their application status, or estimate their tax dues online from home?

PART 6 — FEEDBACK ON THE PROPOSED ONLINE SYSTEM

22. Has your office tried using any digital tools, online forms, or messaging channels for public services in the past? If yes, what worked well and what challenges came up?

23. What concerns or challenges do you foresee if a web-based pre-assessment system is introduced (such as internet stability, staff computer comfort, data privacy, or daily workflow adjustments)?

24. If an online portal allowed taxpayers to check requirements, submit initial papers, and see tax estimates before visiting, which tasks would this reduce or simplify for your staff?

25. Would your office be open to testing the prototype portal with our team (such as running 15 to 20 sample assessments on the system alongside your manual books) to check its speed and calculation accuracy?

26. Are there any local rules, municipal tax ordinances, or unique practices in the Municipality of San Fernando that our research team should know about and build into the system?

Thank You and Commitment:
We sincerely thank the Municipal Assessor and personnel of San Fernando for your generous time and guidance. Your practical insights will help us build a system that solves real daily bottlenecks and improves public service for your municipality.